

we found that the results are more than acceptable. So, for example, if you need general information on any topic—say, flowers—Accessible Search is a good option.

4.2 Google Extensions for Firefox

(<http://www.google.com/tools/firefox/index.html>)

There are only five extensions listed on this page, of which we will discuss only two: Google Browser Sync and Google Notebook. The Google Toolbar has been discussed elsewhere in this book, and the Firefox extension is just a program that makes it work with Firefox.

Of the remaining four, Blogger Web Comments and Google Send to Phone are not compatible with Firefox 2.0 at the time of writing. You're either using version 2.0 right now, or you'll soon be, so we'll have to wait until the releases for that version come out—plus, we're expecting more on this page.

Just for information's sake, Google Send to Phone is an extension that allows you to select text on a page and SMS it to a US phone number, provided you know the person's cell carrier, and Blogger Web Comments allows you to see what bloggers are saying about the site you're at.

Now for Google Browser Sync and Google Notebook.

4.2.1 Google Browser Sync

This is probably one of the most useful Firefox extensions ever. Imagine this work-and-home scenario: at home, you have six tabs open, and you've just bookmarked four sites. If you need to access these tabs at work, you'll have to bookmark these as well, and then, to open all these ten pages at work, you'll need to export the bookmarks and send them across by e-mail—or carry the file on your Flash drive. As for cookies and passwords, whatever happens during your home session is lost for you in your office session.

Imagine using the —same— instance of Firefox at both home and office! All your bookmarks, tabs, cookies and all, visible to both installations! That's what Google Browser Sync does for you. It uploads all your info to a Google server (you need a Google account). When you set up the extension on the first computer, you choose a PIN. Then, when you get to the second computer, say at office, you install the extension, enter your PIN, and all your home settings are restored. From then on, the two (or multiple, if you like) browsers are always in sync—it's all completely automated!

The actual installation and configuration is such a breeze, we won't bother going into it here. It's a matter of clicking Next at each step. One thing we should say is that you can stop or start the syncing at any point—for example, if you visit a page you don't want synced on the other computer, you just click “stop syncing” on the extension's icon.

4.2.2 Google Notebook

This might seem pointless for some, but others might find it a mighty useful extension. It's a little like bookmarking, but instead of keeping a tab on a URL, you keep a tab on any piece of content, including images.

Here's how it works: once you've installed the extension (which involves not much more than clicking “install now” after clicking the link), you'll see a space at the bottom right of Firefox that says “Open Notebook.” Open it, and you'll see a little box with a list of your “notes” (which is initially blank). Now, say you come across something interesting—some text and an image. You select the whole thing and right-click. In the context menu will be an item called “Note this (Google Notebook).” Click that. The selection will get added to your Notebook, and you'll get an indicator in that little box that lists out the first few words of what you noted, along with the URL.

When you want to view all your notes together—reap the harvest of your browsing session, so to speak—maximise the Note-